

SAT READING AND WRITING TEST DAY PLAYBOOK

590 → 600+
Protect the points you
can control

MODULE 1

Protect easy and medium points

- 90 seconds: choose your best answer, flag it, move.
- Bank transition and synthesis questions quickly.
- On grammar, identify structure before choosing punctuation.
- Leave about 4–5 minutes for flagged questions.

GRAMMAR

Complete sentence + complete sentence

Use a period, a semicolon, or comma + FANBOYS. Never use only a comma.

Semicolon = period

If a period would fail, a semicolon fails too.

Colon test

The words before the colon must stand alone as a complete sentence.

Strip the junk

Find the true subject. Ignore distracting phrases between subject and verb.

READING

PROVABLE beats plausible

Use only what the passage gives you. Outside knowledge and “sounds reasonable” do not count.

Down to two?

Stop asking which sounds better. Find the exact word that makes one choice wrong.

Watch for trap words

some	all
may	must
associated	causes
supports	proves

Ugly science passage?

Ignore names and jargon. Reduce the passage to X, Y, more, less, same, supports, or weakens.

HARD MODULE 2

If it feels harder, stay calm

Hard questions are supposed to feel difficult. Harvest every solvable point.

- Inference: choose the smallest conclusion the evidence supports.
- Evidence: identify the claim, then ask what result would support it.
- Graph: title, axes, groups, trend, then question.
- Vocabulary: predict a simple word before viewing choices.
- Function: ask why the author placed the sentence there.
- Two texts: reduce each text to one sentence, then compare.

FINAL REMINDERS

YOUR JOB IS TO ANSWER THE QUESTION.

You do not need to understand every detail. Simplify. Decide. Move.

Answer everything. Never leave a question blank.